

Challenge_5_Walkthrough

Objective

Determine the **birthplace of the primary suspect** by correlating:

- A hotel image containing hidden GPS coordinates
- A separate image of a suspected operative

The final flag is the suspect's **birthplace in the format:**

City-District-Country

Step 1 – Understand the Challenge

Players are given two key artifacts:

1. An image of a hotel following a terrorist attack
2. An image of a suspected operative linked to the incident

The challenge is designed as a **dual-path investigation**, where both forensic and OSINT approaches lead to the same conclusion.

Step 2 – Extract GPS Coordinates from the Hotel Image

Since this is a forensic investigation, players should inspect the image metadata using a tool such as **ExifTool**.

```
exiftool hotel.jpg
```

```
root_user@LAPTOP-F18C06IM:~$ exiftool /mnt/h/Live_Projects/Hacking_projects/OSINT_CTF_Challenges/OSINT_CTF_Challenges/Challenge_5/Mumbai-attacks-26-11.jpg | grep GPS
GPS Version ID       : 2.3.0.0
GPS Latitude Ref     : North
GPS Longitude Ref    : East
GPS Latitude         : 30 deg 52' 52.70" N
GPS Longitude        : 73 deg 35' 58.73" E
GPS Position         : 30 deg 52' 52.70" N, 73 deg 35' 58.73" E
root_user@LAPTOP-F18C06IM:~$
```

Inside the metadata, GPS information is present:

```
GPS Latitude : 30 deg 52' 52.70" N
GPS Longitude : 73 deg 35' 58.73" E
```

(Values may appear in DMS format depending on the tool used.)

Step 3 – Convert Coordinates to a Location

Players should enter the coordinates into a mapping service:

```
30.8813050373722 , 73.5996462544583
```

```
root_user@LAPTOP-F18C06IM:~$
root_user@LAPTOP-F18C06IM:~$ exiftool -n -GPSLatitude -GPSLongitude /mnt/h/Live_Projects/Hacking_projects/OSINT_CTF_Challenges/OSINT_CTF_Challenges/Challenge_5/Mumbai-attacks-26-11.jpg
GPS Latitude       : 30.8813050373722
GPS Longitude      : 73.5996462544583
root_user@LAPTOP-F18C06IM:~$
```

This reveals the **geographical region associated with the attack site**, pointing to a location in Punjab, Pakistan.

Step 4 – Analyze the Suspect Image

The second image shows a suspected operative connected to the attack.

Players should:

- Visually analyze the individual
- Use OSINT techniques (reverse image search, contextual clues)
- Associate the suspect with the same regional network identified via GPS

This confirms that both evidence sources point toward the same operational area.

Step 5 – Correlate Intelligence

By combining both findings:

- GPS metadata → operational region of the attack
- Suspect image → individual linked to that region

Players can identify the suspect and trace background intelligence records.

This leads to the suspect's **biographical origin data**.

Step 6 – Final Answer (Flag)

The confirmed birthplace of the suspect is:

Renala-Khurd-Okara-Pakistan

Final Flag Format

Flag{Renala-Khurd-Okara-Pakistan}

Notes

- GPS data alone is not sufficient — it only provides operational context.
- The suspect image is essential for confirming the correct intelligence profile.
- Final answer must match the exact format: City-District-Country